

Ashin Chakraborty

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PROFILE

A policy analysis and strategy consultant with proven experience presenting data-driven insights to senior stakeholders, including IAS and WBCS officers. Adept at shaping campaign strategy through rigorous political analysis, leveraging skills in R, STATA, and Excel to manage the full research life-cycle. Experienced in overseeing large-scale field surveys (7,000+ observations) and analyzing complex datasets to provide actionable intelligence. A strong communicator with publications in *The Hindu*, *The Indian Express*, *The Wire* and *BBC*, skilled at working under tight deadlines to support high-quality, data-driven campaigns.

SKILLS

- **Data Analysis:** R, STATA, Excel, Predictive Analysis, Descriptive Analysis, Data Cleaning & Validation, Data Quality Control
- **Political Research & Strategy:** Political Analysis, Psephology, Campaign Strategy, Electoral Data, Primary & Secondary Research, Data-Driven Insights, Trend Analysis, Field Surveys
- **Core Competencies:** Research & Reporting, Data Visualization, Stakeholder Presentations, Team Leadership & Training, Project Management, Cross-functional Collaboration
- **Languages:** English, Bengali, Hindi

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sabar Institute

Lead, Research Department

March 2025 - Present

- Spearhead the institute's research division, overseeing the end-to-end execution of multiple data-intensive projects on social and economic indicators.
- Led field operations by managing, training, and mentoring over 500 research interns, establishing data quality standards for large-scale survey projects.
- Developed over 100 data visualizations for reports and presentations, translating complex findings into clear, digestible formats.
- Acted as a trusted advisor by authoring and presenting comprehensive reports on regional challenges to key stakeholders, including Members of Parliament and senior government officials (IAS/WBCS), to inform policy and strategy.

Research Assistant

September 2024 - March 2025

- Assisted senior researchers by gathering and compiling relevant datasets from diverse internal and external sources.
- Conducted rigorous data cleaning and validation to ensure accuracy and consistency across research projects.
- Provided ad-hoc research support for ongoing initiatives, contributing to data analysis and interpretation.

Psephology Intern under Aparna Bhattacharya

June 2024

- Contributed to campaign strategy for the 2024 Lok Sabha Election by delivering rapid-response research and analysis of electoral data to inform strategic decisions.
- Identified and escalated data discrepancies to ensure the integrity of strategic insights.
- Collaborated with the team to interpret data trends and contribute to campaign strategy.

KEY RESEARCH & ANALYSIS PROJECTS

- **Gender, Social Identity, and Voter Deletion: Evidence from the 2026 Special Intensive Revision of Electoral Rolls in West Bengal** Dec 2024 - Present
by Ashin Chakraborty, Sabir Ahamed and Souptik Halder
Co-authored an ongoing large-scale empirical study examining voter exclusions during the 2026 Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls across 294 Assembly constituencies and ~80,000 polling booths in West Bengal. Designed and implemented a web-scraping pipeline to extract and structure Electoral Commission of India roll data, compiling a dataset of 150+ million individual voter records. Developed and deployed machine learning classification models to infer voter characteristics (gender, religion, and caste) from names at scale, enabling disaggregated analysis of deletions and exclusions. Conducted constituency- and booth-level analysis to identify systematic patterns of voter deletion across social groups, with a focus on gender and minority representation. Contributed to data validation, bias checks, and robustness exercises to ensure reliability of large-scale automated classifications. Co-authoring a working paper intended for academic and policy audiences, with implications for electoral integrity, representation, and democratic participation.
- **Status of Education in Metiabruz** May 2025 - Present
Leading the research component for a large-scale primary survey. Currently overseeing a team of 60+ surveyors in the collection of over 4,000 interviews to assess the state of education in the region.
- **A Survey on Changing Reading Habits in the Age of Digital Distraction** June 2025 - Present
Guiding 30+ students from Sarojini Naidu College in a survey assessing the impact of smartphones and public library access on the reading habits of diverse populations across Kolkata and North 24 Parganas.
- **Survey on Access to Public Toilets by Informal Sector Women in Kolkata** April 2025 - June 2025
Managed an end-to-end data collection and analysis project; directed a team of over 300 surveyors to gather a new dataset of more than 7,000 observations, ensuring data integrity from collection through to the final analysis phase.
- **Impact Study of Pre-Recruitment Coaching of West Bengal Police Force** Dec 2024 - Jan 2025
Executed a targeted impact study involving the collection of 300 samples across five districts, followed by data analysis and the presentation of findings to government officials.
- **Assessing Representation in Government Bodies of West Bengal: An Analysis of Gender, Caste, and Religious Diversity** Sept 2024 -
Developed a novel dataset with 600+ entries to analyze diversity in government bodies; compiled and structured data to assess the politics of presence in decision-making bodies.
- **Understanding Caste-Based Crimes: A Socio-Economic Investigation** Aug 2024 - June 2025
Executed a comprehensive data research project by compiling, cleaning, and validating over 600 district-level crime records. Developed statistical models to identify and analyze key trends, ensuring accuracy across the dataset.
- **Macro-Stabilization and Policy Reforms in India: Some Reflections on Health Outcomes in the Post-COVID Era** June 2024
Estimated the monetary benefits of COVID-19 vaccination and analyzed the long-term impact of the ICDS program over the years.
- **Raiders of the Lost Female Workforce: Lakshmir Bhandar and the Backward Bending Labor Supply Curve** April 2024
Wrote a paper on unconditional cash transfers to women, which involved conducting a primary

survey and reviewing existing research papers. Developed a custom model and tested the acquired data against it.

- **Rethinking the Impact of the Singur Movement on Industrialization in West Bengal: A Comprehensive Analysis using Qualitative & Quantitative Evidence** Sept 2024
Conducted extensive historical data research, identifying and synthesizing over 20 datasets comprising more than 600 data points spanning 75 years to publish a comprehensive case study.
- **The Green Gatsby: Illuminating the Influence of Human Development on Sustainable Futures** September 2023
Wrote a paper on sustainable development using large datasets and statistical models, including regression analysis, to establish associations between various economic variables. Presented the findings to an audience.
- **The Missing Educated Women from Labor Force in India: A Study on Access to Vocational Training** May 2022
Authored an article analyzing the declining female labor force participation rate (LFPR) using large, nationally representative datasets. Developed a comprehensive presentation using PowerPoint to convey the findings to an audience.

MEDIA MENTIONS & PUBLICATIONS

Quoted as an Expert Commentator

- British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC)
- *The Hindu*
- *The Indian Express*
- *The Times of India*
- *The Telegraph*
- *Anandabazar Patrika*
- *Ei Samay*

Authored Articles

- *The Indian Express*: In India, fire safety remains elusive. Why and how to fix this?
- *The Wire*: Bulldozers Reflect the Clash of Development and Displacement in Bengal
- *The Wire*: Overpromising and Underdelivering: The Reality of West Bengal Muslims Under TMC Rule

ACHIEVEMENTS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Invited Participant, **OpenAI Academy** Nonprofit Jam, Kolkata – January 2026
- UGC-NET (2024), 99.7 percentile
- Best Paper Award, Confluence XVI, St. Xavier's College (Autonomous), Kolkata
- Runner-up, Young Economist of The Year Award 2024, Jadavpur University, Dept. of Economics
- Champion, Youth Parliament Competition, Dept. of Parliamentary Affairs, Govt. of West Bengal, 2017
- GATE (2023)

EDUCATION

- **MSc in Economics** 2023-2025
University of Calcutta
CGPA: 6.3 (First Class)
- **BSc (Hons) in Economics** 2020-2023
University of Calcutta
CGPA: 8.0